5.1 Introduction to Probability

1. Probability of an Events

$$P(A) = \frac{\text{Number of favorable outcomes (Outcomes in A)}}{\text{Total number of possible outcomes}}$$

*Note: This counting formula works when all outcomes are equally likely

Range of Value: $0 \leq P(A) \leq 1$

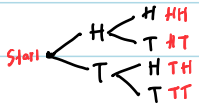
P(A)	Meaning
0	Impossible, it never happens
1	Certain, it always happen (100%)
0.3	30% Chance A happen

2. Sample Space and tree diagram

The sample space S is the set of all possible outcomes.

One coin: $S = \{H, T\}$

Two Coin: $S = \{HH, HT, TH, TT\}$



05.2 Probability Formulas, Symbols & Notations – Marginal, Joint, and Conditional Probabilities

1. Marginal probability – a single event

The probability of one event, regardless of any others:

$$P(A) = \frac{\text{Favorable Outcomes in event A}}{\text{Total Outcomes in Sample Space}}$$

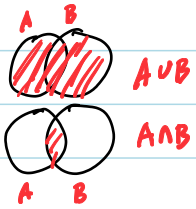
example 1: • Sample Space $S = \{1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9\}$

• "Event" $A = \{1,2,3,4\}$ $B = \{6,7,8\}$ $C = \{1,7,8,9\}$

$P(A) = \frac{4}{9} = 44.44\%$ $P(B) = \frac{3}{9} = 33.33\%$. $P(C) = \frac{4}{9} = 44.4\%$

2. Union and Intersection Symbols

Symbols	Name	Meaning
$A \cup B$	Union	Everything in A or B (or both), listed once
$A \cap B$	Intersection	Only what is in both A and B



Example 1:

$A \cup B = \{1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8\}$

$A \cap B = \{\text{None}\}$

$B \cup C = \{1,6,7,8,9\}$

$B \cap C = \{7,8\}$

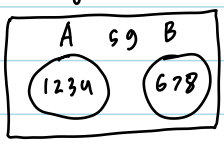
3. Union Probability – "A or B" Addition Rule

$$P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$$

$P(A \cup B)$: $P(A$ or $B)$ — $P(A \cap B)$: $P(A$ and $B)$

The Subtraction stops $A \cap B$ being counted twice.

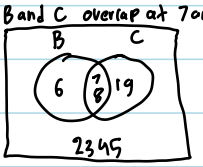
• Mutually exclusive events can't happen together, so $A \cap B \neq \emptyset$ and $P(A \cap B) = 0$: **Mutually Exclusive A, B**



$P(A \cup B) = \frac{7}{9} = 0.778 = P(A) + P(B) = \frac{4}{9} + \frac{3}{9}$

• Example overlap at 7 and 8: $B \cap C = \{7,8\}$ so $P(B \cap C) = \frac{2}{9}$: **Not Mutually Exclusive B, C**

B and C overlap at 7 and 8



$P(B \cup C) = \frac{5}{9} = P(B) + P(C) - P(B \cap C) = \frac{4}{9} + \frac{3}{9} - \frac{2}{9} = \frac{5}{9}$

4. Joint Probability - $P(A \cap B)$ (multiplication rule)

- $P(A \cap B)$ is read "The probability of A and B" (both happen):
  - ↳ Words: $P(A \text{ and } B) = P(A \text{ given } B)\ P(B) = P(B \text{ given } A)\ P(A)$
  - ↳ Symbols: $P(A \cap B) = P(A|B)\,P(B) = P(B|A)\,P(A)$

On the **Independent events** (one doesn't affect the others): $P(A|B) = P(A)$ and $P(B|A) = P(B)$, so

Words: $P(A \text{ and } B) = P(A)\,P(B)$

Symbols: $P(A \cap B) = P(A)\,P(B)$

- Independent or dependent?
  - Situation: Draw a red marble, **Put it back**, then draw blue one
    - Type: Independent.
    - Why: Replacing the marble restore the bag.
  - Situation: Draw a red marble, **keep it**, then draw blue one
    - Type: Dependent.
    - Why: The bag now has one fewer marble, so the second probability change.
  - Situation: Toss a coin Twice
    - Type: Independent
    - Why: The first toss doesn't affect a second toss.

- Notation Warning: $P(A \cap B)$ vs $P(AB)$
  - $P(A \cap B) = P(B \cap A)$: both happen, no order implied.
  - Some books write $P(AB)$ for "A first, then B" and $P(BA)$ for "B first, then A". These are not always equal.
  - Read the context: are the events simultaneous, or does one come before the other?

5. Conditional Probability - "A given B"

$P(A|B)$ is the probability of A **given that** B **has already happened**.

we know that $P(A \cap B) = P(A|B)\,P(B) = P(B|A)\,P(A)$

So

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)}, \qquad P(B|A) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(A)}$$

Conditional = Joint / Marginal

6. Bayes' Theorem

Replacing $P(A \cap B)$ with $P(B|A)\,P(A)$

$$P(A|B) = \frac{P(B|A)\,P(A)}{P(B)}$$

Replacing $P(A \cap B)$ with $P(A|B)\,P(B)$

$$P(B|A) = \frac{P(A|B)\,P(B)}{P(A)}$$

7. Negation (Complement) Probability

Words: $P(\text{not } A) = 1 - P(A)$

Symbols: $P(A') = 1 - P(A)$

$P(A')$ is read "The probability of Not A". The complement is also written A^c (The most common form in textbook), $\bar{A}$ or $\sim A$

example 1:

$P(A') = 1 - P(A) = 1 - \frac{4}{9} = \frac{5}{9}$

$P(B) = 0.35$ then $P(B') = 1 - 0.35 = 0.65$, a 65% chance that B doesnot occur.

>Formula Summary

Type	Words	Symbols
Marginal	$P(A) = \frac{\text{favorable}}{\text{total}}$	(same)
Union (or)	$P(A \text{ or } B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \text{ and } B)$	$P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$
Union, mutually exclusive	$P(A \text{ or } B) = P(A) + P(B)$	$P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B)$
Joint (and)	$P(A \text{ and } B) = P(A \text{ given } B)P(B) = P(B \text{ given } A)P(A)$	$P(A \cap B) = P(A \mid B)P(B) = P(B \mid A)P(A)$
Joint, independent	$P(A \text{ and } B) = P(A)P(B)$	$P(A \cap B) = P(A)P(B)$
Conditional	$P(A \text{ given } B) = \frac{P(A \text{ and } B)}{P(B)}$	$P(A \mid B) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)}$
Bayes	$P(A \text{ given } B) = \frac{P(B \text{ given } A)P(A)}{P(B)}$	$P(A \mid B) = \frac{P(B \mid A)P(A)}{P(B)}$
Complement	$P(\text{not } A) = 1 - P(A)$	$P(A') = 1 - P(A)$